CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

MOBILE PET GROOMER IN THE AI ERA

Salons make dogs wait in cages for hours. The van that comes to the driveway sells calm — and charges for it.

★ TL;DR — Around ~$75K on the site's scale for a booked mobile groomer, startable in 1–6 months if you can already groom. The catch: drive time is unpaid time — route discipline decides your real hourly rate. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

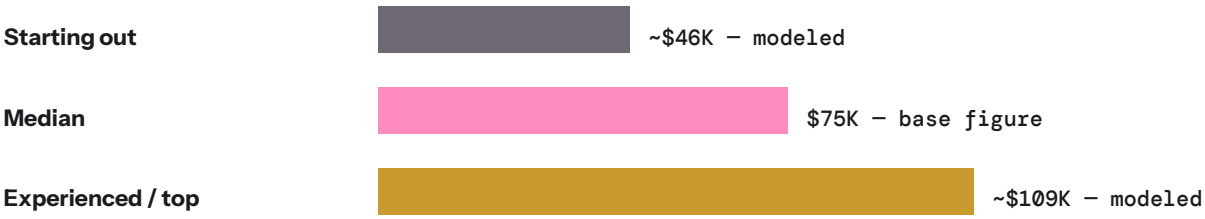
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Mobile commands premium prices: one dog, no cages, at the client's home.
- The van is a salon on wheels — water, power and climate included.
- Booking software fills the route; grooming skill is the product being routed.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Mobile Pet Groomer is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A MOBILE PET GROOMER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Drive a route of homes, grooming dogs start to finish in the van
- ✓ Bathe, cut, nails and deshedding by breed and coat

✓ Manage water, power, waste and van sanitation between stops

✓ Rebook clients on a standing cycle before leaving the driveway

Think: a food truck, but the kitchen is a salon and the special is a doodle.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Routing, booking, reminders and payment apps run the business end. Client notes and photos standardize each dog's groom.	Handling anxious dogs solo, adapting cuts to real coats, and being trusted with keys and garages — the service is the groomer's calm.

⚠ **Van costs and maintenance are a second rent; one breakdown cancels a full day of premium appointments.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Premium per-dog prices and tips ✓ No salon drama and no cage-dryer chaos — your van, your rules ✓ Clients rebook standing appointments months ahead	✗ Unpaid windshield time between stops ✗ You're the groomer, the driver and the van mechanic's first call ✗ Solo means no backup when you're sick

Good fit? A trained groomer who likes independence and tight scheduling.
Bad fit? You can't groom yet, or you hate driving and logistics.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — GROOM IN A SALON, THEN GO MOBILE	DOOR B — BUY THE VAN, HIRE THE SKILL (CAREFULLY)
Build grooming skill and speed in a salon first (bather to groomer), learn your per-dog times, then launch mobile with a following and realistic route math.	Some operators buy a converted van and employ a groomer while learning the business — viable only with a great groomer hire, because clients follow the hands, not the van.

Smart move: Build routes by neighborhood day: one area on Mondays, another on Tuesdays — density turns drive time into groom time.
Where you land after: A booked-out van → a second van and groomer → a small mobile fleet.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PROVE YOUR	PRICE THE	SET UP	LAUNCH ONE	TIGHTEN THE	ADD THE

STEP 1 — Prove your grooming speed

FREE · TODAY

- Time full grooms by breed and coat; mobile pricing depends on it.
- If you can't groom solo yet, salon training is step zero.

STEP 2 — Price the model

WEEKS

- Set per-dog prices with a travel premium and a minimum stop charge.
- Map target neighborhoods by density of dog-owning homes.

STEP 3 — Set up van and business

MONTHS 1-3

- A converted grooming van (bought or built): tub, table, water, power, climate.
- Register the business and insure the vehicle and the work properly.

STEP 4 — Launch one neighborhood

MONTHS 2-4

- Founding clients from your salon network, vets and neighborhood groups.
- Rebook every dog on a 4–8 week cycle before you leave.

STEP 5 — Tighten the route

ONGOING

- Group stops geographically; cap daily dogs at quality, not greed.
- Track your true hourly including drive time — that's your scoreboard.

STEP 6 — Add the second area or van

MONTH 6+

- Expand only into adjacent dense neighborhoods.
- A second van needs a groomer you trust more than the van.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: time your grooms and draft route pricing.
- Days 1–30: van sourced; business and insurance set.
- Days 31–60: first neighborhood launched; standing rebooks starting.
- Days 61–90: route days fixed by area; true hourly tracked weekly.
- Day 90: a premium mobile route running — growth is density, then a second van.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ THE SALON COMES TO YOU. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.